Watch Polar Bears Live as They Wait for the Ice in Canada

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Fat Bear Week in Alaska is over, but there are more bears to watch online. Explore.org and Polar Bears International run eight **livestreams** from Churchill, Manitoba, in Canada. Churchill is known as the polar bear capital of the world.

In October and November, viewers can watch polar bear families waiting for sea ice to form on Hudson Bay. Wapusk National Park, near Churchill, has one of the world's largest groups of polar bear **maternity dens**, where mothers give birth to cubs. Many of these dens were first dug by bears generations ago.

In this part of the **Arctic**, the sea ice melts completely in summer, usually in July. The bears mostly rest on land during the warm months. In the fall, they become more active and move to the coast. From early October, they gather along the shore of Hudson Bay. As soon as the ice is thick enough to hold them, they head out to hunt seals.

The cameras also help scientists. In December 2025, scientists confirmed that a wild mother polar bear had **adopted** a cub that was not her own. In spring 2025, she came out of her den with one tagged cub. By fall, she had two cubs, and only one had a tag. Cameras captured this rare behavior.

There is more to see. Viewers can ride along on the Tundra Buggy Lodge, a moving hotel made of linked vehicles, like a train. At night, a camera shows the **northern lights** dancing across the sky. Late winter and early spring are the best times to watch them.

Bird fans can also check out a raven cam, where ravens built a nest on top of an old observation tower.

Word Treasure

livestreams -- Videos shown on the internet live, as things happen.

maternity dens -- Snow or earth shelters where mother bears give birth and care for cubs.

Arctic -- The very cold region around the North Pole.

adopted -- Took in and raised a young one that was not its own.

northern lights -- Glowing, colorful lights that appear in the night sky near the far north.

Background you need

Polar bears live in the Arctic and depend on sea ice as a platform for hunting seals, their main food.

Around Hudson Bay in Canada, the sea ice melts each summer, so the bears spend those months on land and return to the ice when the bay freezes again in late fall.

Scientists put tags on some bears so they can recognize them and follow their lives over time.

Wildlife cameras let scientists and the public watch animal behavior without disturbing the animals.

Break it down

LEAD: Eight livestreams from Churchill, Manitoba, let people watch polar bears
KEY EVENT: Bears gather on Hudson Bay's shore waiting for sea ice
+- WHO: Explore.org and Polar Bears International
+- WHEN: October and November
HOW IT WORKS: Ice melts in summer; bears rest on land, then hunt seals once the bay freezes
SCIENCE: Cameras captured a mother bear that adopted a cub in 2025
MORE CAMERAS: Tundra Buggy Lodge, northern lights and a raven nest
OPEN QUESTION: What will viewers spot as the ice season begins?

Why it matters

Livestreams let anyone watch wild animals and help scientists record rare behavior, like a polar bear adopting a cub.

Test what you remember

1. How many livestreams do Explore.org and Polar Bears International run from Churchill?

(A) Fifty
(B) One
(C) Twenty
(D) Eight

2. What is Churchill, Manitoba, known as?

(A) The capital of Canada
(B) The polar bear capital of the world
(C) The coldest city on Earth
(D) The home of Fat Bear Week

3. What are the polar bears waiting for in October and November?

(A) Their dens to melt
(B) Salmon to swim upstream
(C) Summer to arrive
(D) Sea ice to form on Hudson Bay

4. What do the bears hunt once the ice is thick enough?

(A) Fish in rivers
(B) Berries
(C) Birds
(D) Seals

5. How did scientists know the mother bear had adopted a cub?

(A) A visitor saw it happen
(B) The cub was a different color
(C) The cub was much older
(D) Only one of her two cubs had a tag

6. What is the Tundra Buggy Lodge?

(A) A science lab under the ice
(B) A moving hotel made of linked vehicles
(C) A boat on Hudson Bay
(D) A snow fort for bears

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: D 4: D 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):